

LAURA DOWELL BALLESTA

CREATIVE TECHNOLOGIST

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📍 Cambridge, UK

EXPERIENCE

Creative Technologist & Research Intern | Microsoft Research

Jun 2025 – Oct-2025

- Working within **Game Intelligence**, building new types of **AI-powered interactive experiences**.
- Built a **Unity-based autonomous data collection pipeline and UI for AI training** that enabled overnight agentic wandering without human supervision, improving team productivity and data personalisation. This data was used by fellow researchers and team members and was used in a paper currently under review.
- Led collaboration across teams, culminating in the **deployment of real-world multi-stream automated video and CSV data collection using a Hello-Robot**.
- Authored applied scenarios and storyboards based on our **WHAM model capabilities**; one concept was adopted, which catalysed team workshops and **shaped the team's future research direction**. It was also used in the company-wide Hackathon **and received first place in our lab**.
- Built and deployed an **audio interface** for an internal Hackathon. This was part of a game experience prototype powered by our **WHAM model**, and was used for user studies with people from industry. **Audio processing** and retrieval were required, and an **organised structure** using Figma was made to show a visual representation of the audio file structure. Thanks to the attention to detail, I achieved a realistic and seamless experience that **convinced users of the audio being real-time**.
- Developed a **software prototype** that allows artists and creatives to use data as a creative material in the process of model training for their creative practice, shifting the paradigm toward **human-ai collaboration**.

Generative A.I. Intern | The LEGO Group

Oct 2023 - Apr 2024

- Initiated and prototyped a **storytelling LLM project** within the Creative Play Lab, demonstrating the **next generation of toys and future LEGO products**. This prototype used physical play detected through Hardware interactions to prompt a story using TTS and an audio experience that accompanied the child's play.
- **Showcased this project company-wide and to the executive team at LEGO**, earning significant recognition and prompting **organisation-wide workshops** and collaboration for expansion. Worked with the Billund (Denmark) team to further develop the project, gaining valuable cross-cultural teamwork experience. I was named **Main Inventor** in the project, which is now in the **patenting** process.

Volunteer and IOS Developer | Community Tech Aid

Nov 2022 - Aug 2023

- Developed a SwiftUI iOS app aligned with the charity's mission, featuring a **user-friendly interface based on beneficiary interviews**. Designed wireframes in **Figma** and refined the UX through **iterative feedback**.
- **Led workshops to teach tech literacy**, promoting **digital inclusion in the community**.

Building Imagination | Coding, Robotics and VR club leader

Sep 2022 - Jul 2023

- Taught **Robotics, Coding and VR to children** (ages 3–11) in after-school clubs and helped develop curriculum **incorporating K–12 AI literacy principles**. This inspired many of the projects in my portfolio.

EDUCATION

Masters by Research in UX and UI Design	Universidad Oberta Catalunya	2024 - 2025
Bachelor of Science in Creative Computing	University of the Arts London	2020 - 2024
Foundation in Art and Design	Central Saint Martin's (UAL), London	2019 – 2020

LANGUAGES: NATIVE ENGLISH, NATIVE SPANISH, B2 FRENCH (DELF CERTIFIED), A2 ITALIAN

SKILLS: Large Language Models (LLMs) • Text-to-Speech • Text-to-Image/Video/Audio • Machine Learning • Python • JavaScript • Unity •Generative A.I. • Prototyping • Interface Design • Wireframing • Information Architecture • Creative Brainstorming • Figma • Adobe Creative Suite • Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) • Usability Testing • User Research • User Interviews • C++ (Arduino) • SwiftUI • API Integration • Data Scraping • Big Data Analysis • 3D Modelling (Blender) • 3D Printing • Laser Cutting